ATL DEV CON

# Trust doesn’t rust

## Engineering guardrails for AI coding agents

Drew Schillinger
Enterprise Architect and community builder

17 October 2026
FCS Innovation Academy, Alpharetta

OUR PATH

- Overview
- Skills
- Harness
- Routing
- Demonstration
- Evidence
- Discussion
- Appendix

TRUST

# Trust needs current evidence

OUR PATH


- Overview
- Skills
- Harness
- Routing
- Demonstration
- Evidence
- Discussion
- Appendix


## What was accepted

A specification, source state and test evidence.

A receipt records the accepted attempt.

## What changed

Changed source can make earlier evidence stale.

The controller rechecks current bindings.

> Confidence has a scope and a source revision.

scripts/nightshift-pipeline.py; scripts/nightshift-cleanup.py

OVERVIEW

# The harness keeps the workflow

OUR PATH


- Overview
- Skills
- Harness
- Routing
- Demonstration
- Evidence
- Discussion
- Appendix


## Entry point

A skill or CLI starts the work.

## Canonical instructions

Stages and roles define the work.

## Routing

Configuration selects the provider.

## Controller

Evidence determines the next stage.

AGENTS.md; skills/nightshift/SKILL.md; routing.json; scripts/nightshift-pipeline.py

# The skill is the entry point

OUR PATH

✓ Overview
• Skills
○ Harness
○ Routing
○ Demonstration
○ Evidence
○ Discussion
○ Appendix

CODEX SKILL

```
$nightshift <ticket-ref>
```

The adapter loads the canonical stage instructions.

A ticket starts the engineering pipeline without separate calls for each stage.

SKILLS

# The instructions stay in the repository

OUR PATH

- ✓ Overview
- • Skills
- ○ Harness
- ○ Routing
- ○ Demonstration
- ○ Evidence
- ○ Discussion
- ○ Appendix

| | |
|---|---|
| commands/ | Canonical stage instructions |
| agents/ | Reusable role instructions |
| scripts/ | Execution and validation |
| routing.json | Provider and model selection |

AGENTS.md; commands/nightshift-product.md; agents/nightshift-spec-writer.md

# Six stages retain their evidence

OUR PATH

✓ Overview

✓ Skills

• Harness

○ Routing

○ Demonstration

○ Evidence

○ Discussion

○ Appendix

1

## Product

Specification and scope

2

## Adversarial

Independent challenge

3

## Implementation

Tests and source changes

4

## Review

Independent code review

5

## Drift

Specification alignment

6

## QA

Final verification

commands/nightshift-{product,adversarial,implement,review,drift,qa}.md

# A small task makes proof visible

OUR PATH

✓ Overview

✓ Skills

• Harness

○ Routing

○ Demonstration

○ Evidence

○ Discussion

○ Appendix

PUBLIC DURATION FORMATTER

```
format_seconds(0)    == "0:00"
format_seconds(125)  == "2:05"
format_seconds(3600) == "60:00"
```

## Acceptance cases

Nonnegative integers format correctly.

Negative integers raise an error.

Booleans and other types raise an error.

# Routing selects the worker

OUR PATH

✓ Overview

✓ Skills

✓ Harness

• Routing

○ Demonstration

○ Evidence

○ Discussion

○ Appendix

**Author path**

Codex

`gpt-6.1-sol`

Product and Implementation

**Independent review path**

Claude

`sonnet`

Adversarial, Review, Drift and QA

> These are the recorded routes for this acceptance run.

routing.json; accepted controller receipts for issue 133

# Admission happens before dispatch

OUR PATH

✓ Overview

✓ Skills

✓ Harness

• Routing

○ Demonstration

○ Evidence

○ Discussion

○ Appendix

## Provider capability

Required runtime and tools are available.

## Local inventory

The configured local model exists before extraction starts.

## Retained allowance

Existing call and active-time limits still apply.

## Bounded context

Stage handoffs carry relevant files and findings.

scripts/nightshift-capability.sh; scripts/nightshift-ticket-budget.py; scripts/nightshift-handoff.py

DEMONSTRATION

# The front end shows the evidence

OUR PATH

- ✓ Overview
- ✓ Skills
- ✓ Harness
- ✓ Routing
- • Demonstration
- ○ Evidence
- ○ Discussion
- ○ Appendix




Routes, receipts, artifacts and retained attempts remain inspectable.

Actual dashboard capture of the verified public rehearsal

DEMONSTRATION

# Watch Nightshift work

OUR PATH

- ✓ Overview
- ✓ Skills
- ✓ Harness
- ✓ Routing
- • Demonstration
- ○ Evidence
- ○ Discussion
- ○ Appendix

PRESENTER TERMINAL · FROM THE COMMUNITY CHECKOUT

```
python3 scripts/nightshift-talk-check.py
```

Recheck six stage receipts, real tests and both proof gates.

Repeat the retained task with zero new generation calls.

Open the local dashboard ↗ · Demo setup and commands ↗

Presenter laptop: retained fixture and subscription login required. Cached repeat, not a fresh agent run.

DEMONSTRATION

# RED and GREEN remain inspectable

OUR PATH

- ✓ Overview
- ✓ Skills
- ✓ Harness
- ✓ Routing
- • Demonstration
- ○ Evidence
- ○ Discussion
- ○ Appendix

**Before implementation**

Retained RED evidence records expected test failures.

Frozen cases define the required behavior.

**After implementation**

The real tests pass.

Development and final proof gates both pass.

> The rejected receipt stays in history.

commands/nightshift-implement.md; docs/133/IMPLEMENTATION.md

EVIDENCE

# Zero generation calls on repeat

OUR PATH

- ✓ Overview
- ✓ Skills
- ✓ Harness
- ✓ Routing
- ✓ Demonstration
- • Evidence
- ○ Discussion
- ○ Appendix

| 6 | 0 | 26 |
| --- | --- | --- |
| accepted stages | additional generation calls | unchanged call reservations |

Receipt hashes and attempt history stayed unchanged.

Current bindings allow the controller to reuse accepted work.

docs/133/VALIDATION.json; retained repeat-validation.json

# Verification has a defined scope

OUR PATH

✓ Overview

✓ Skills

✓ Harness

✓ Routing

✓ Demonstration

• Evidence

○ Discussion

○ Appendix

## Observed

One public task passed all six stages.

Both proof gates and repeat reuse passed.

Ten CI shards and dashboard checks passed.

## Still outside this evidence

Reliability across arbitrary projects

Actual provider billed charges

Hermes or Jev accuracy and savings

docs/133/VALIDATION.json; GitHub Actions run 38600812302

DEEP DIVE

# Human checkpoints

OUR PATH

- ✓ Overview
- ✓ Skills
- ✓ Harness
- ✓ Routing
- ✓ Demonstration
- • Evidence
- ○ Discussion
- ○ Appendix

## Declared operating mode

Supervised planning waits for approval.

Autonomous planning records its plan and continues.

## Explicit boundaries

Production deployment requires confirmation.

Permanent removal requires confirmation.

> Passing a test does not grant new authority.

AGENTS.md; commands/nightshift-implement.md

ATL DEV CON

# Trust doesn’t rust

Keep the specification, current source and evidence connected.

github.com/doctor-ew/nightshift-community

Questions and discussion

OUR PATH

- ✓ Overview
- ✓ Skills
- ✓ Harness
- ✓ Routing
- ✓ Demonstration
- ✓ Evidence
- • Discussion
- ○ Appendix

APPENDIX

# Testing the retained demo

OUR PATH

- ✓ Overview
- ✓ Skills
- ✓ Harness
- ✓ Routing
- ✓ Demonstration
- ✓ Evidence
- ✓ Discussion
- • Appendix

FROM THE COMMUNITY CHECKOUT

```
python3 scripts/nightshift-talk-check.py
```

The checker validates identity, receipts, proof and real tests.

The repeat check refuses new provider generation.

scripts/nightshift-talk-check.py; docs/talks/TESTING.md

DEEP DIVE

# SOLID and ACID in review

OUR PATH

- ✓ Overview
- ✓ Skills
- ✓ Harness
- ✓ Routing
- ✓ Demonstration
- ✓ Evidence
- ✓ Discussion
- • Appendix

## SOLID

Responsibilities and interface contracts

Dependencies and extension points

## ACID

Validation and consistent state

Isolation and recovery for state changes

> These are review lenses. Findings still need evidence.

commands/nightshift-review.md